

"All the News
That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, breezy, mixture of clouds and sun, high 69. Tonight, mainly clear, light winds, low 52. Tomorrow, dry, partly sunny, warmer, light winds, high 73. Weather map, Page 23.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



Swimmers near a ferry dock in Vietnam's Hung Yen province, an area expected to be cleared for a Trump family development.

Vietnam's Rush to Rip Up Land for a Trump Golf Complex

By DAMIEN CAVE

HUNG YEN PROVINCE, Vietnam — When officials in the home province of Vietnam's top leader went door to door recently, pressing residents to sign letters agreeing to the Trump Organization's plans for a new golf community, Le Van Truong wanted to refuse. Planning documents promised a "new benchmark in luxury, recreation and business," Mr. Truong, 54, pictured something else: the uprooting of a cemetery with five generations of his ancestors and the loss of rich farmland that has

sustained local families for centuries. Yet he signed anyway, because, as he put it, "there's nothing I can do."

"Trump says it's separate — the presidency and his business," Mr. Truong said. "But he has the power to do whatever he wants."

This \$1.5 billion golf complex outside the capital, Hanoi, as well as plans for a Trump skyscraper in Ho Chi Minh City, are the Trump family's first projects in Vietnam — part of a global moneymaking enterprise that no family of a sitting American president has ever

Skirting Its Own Laws, in Light of Levies

attempted on this scale. And as that blitz makes the Trumps richer, it is distorting how countries interact with the United States.

To fast-track the Trump development, Vietnam has ignored its own laws, legal experts said, granting concessions more generous than what even the most connected locals receive. Vietnamese

officials, in a letter obtained by The New York Times, explicitly stated that the project required special support from the top ranks of the Vietnamese government because it was "receiving special attention from the Trump administration and President Donald Trump personally."

And Vietnamese officials have waved the development along in a moment of high-stakes diplomacy. They face intense pressure to strike a trade deal that would head off President Trump's threat of steep tariffs, which would hit

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5 Years Later, Right Reframes Killing of Floyd

By SHAILA DEWAN

When the world saw the video of George Floyd taking his last breath under the knee of a police officer while onlookers pleaded for his life, the outrage was universal. Republicans and Democrats agreed it was horrific, as did police chiefs and rank-and-file officers, and protesters of every race in towns large and small.

"It is important to recognize that everyone should be on the same side of this," Ben Shapiro, the prominent conservative commentator, said back then, adding, "It's police brutality, obviously." In a televised trial, the officer, Derek Chauvin, was convicted of murder and sentenced to 22.5 years in prison.

Five years later, that consensus has disintegrated. The right-wing reshaping of the narrative of that day is in full swing, to the point where Mr. Shapiro is calling on President Trump to pardon Mr. Chauvin.

In the right's retelling, Mr. Floyd did not die from being deprived of air, and Mr. Chauvin was railroaded by a country that flew into a panic over race and did not consider the facts soberly. To build this case, conservatives have packaged misleading details from court documents, images of burning and looting during the protests, Mr. Floyd's criminal record

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JOHNNY MILLER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Beach and Barbecue Bites

It's the unofficial start of summer, and you're going to want to eat outdoors. We've got you covered with 24 highly portable recipes from snacks to sweets for wherever you're headed. Special Section.

How Russia's Spy Factory Assembled Moles in Brazil

Operatives Spent Years Creating Identities, Then Infiltrated Other Countries

By MICHAEL SCHWIRTZ and JANE BRADLEY

RIO DE JANEIRO — Artem Shmyrev had everyone fooled. The Russian intelligence officer seemed to have built the perfect cover identity. He ran a successful 3-D printing business and shared an upscale apartment in Rio de Janeiro with his Brazilian girlfriend and a fluffy orange-and-white Maine coon cat.

But most important, he had an authentic birth certificate and passport that cemented his alias as Gerhard Daniel Campos Wittich, a 34-year-old Brazilian citizen.

After six years lying low, he was impatient to begin real spy work. "No one wants to feel loser," he wrote in a 2021 text message to his Russian wife, who was also an intelligence officer, using imperfect English. "That is why I continue working and hoping."

He was not alone. For years, a New York Times investigation found, Russia used Brazil as a launchpad for its most elite intelligence officers, known as illegals. In an audacious and far-reaching operation, the spies shed their Russian pasts. They started businesses, made friends and had love affairs — events that, over many years, became the building blocks of entirely new identities.

Major Russian spy operations have been uncovered in the past, including in the United States in 2010. This was different. The goal was not to spy on Brazil, but to become Brazilian. Once cloaked in credible back stories, they would set off for the United States, Europe or the Middle East and begin working in earnest.

The Russians essentially turned Brazil into an assembly line for deep-cover operatives like Mr. Shmyrev.

One started a jewelry business. Another was a blond, blue-eyed model. A third was admitted into an American university. There was a Brazilian researcher who landed work in Norway, and a married couple who eventually went to Portugal.

Then it all came crashing down. For the past three years, Brazilian counterintelligence agents have quietly and methodically hunted these spies. Through painstaking police work, these agents discovered a pattern that allowed them to identify the spies, one by one.

Agents have uncovered at least nine Russian officers operating under Brazilian cover identities, according to documents and interviews. Six have not been publicly identified until now. The investigation has already spanned at least eight countries, officials said, with intelligence coming from the United States, Israel, the Netherlands, Uruguay and other Western security services.

Using hundreds of investigative documents and interviews with dozens of police and intelligence officials across three continents, The Times pieced together details of the Russian spy operation in Brazil and the secretive effort to take it out.

Dismantling the Kremlin's spy factory was more than just a routine task.

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SPY GAME A review of birth certificates used by operatives offers a tantalizing possibility. PAGE 9

Pivoting From Tax Cuts to Tariffs, Trump Ignores the Warning Signs

By TONY ROMM and COLBY SMITH

WASHINGTON — One day after House Republicans approved an expensive package of tax cuts that rattled financial markets, President Trump pivoted back to his other signature policy priority, unveiling a battery of tariff threats that further spooked investors and raised the prospects of higher prices on American consumers.

For a president who has fashioned himself as a shrewd steward of the economy, the decision to escalate his global trade war on Friday appeared curious and costly. It capped off a week that saw Mr. Trump ignore repeated warnings that his agenda could worsen the nation's debt, harm many of his own voters, hurt the finances of low-income families and contribute far less in growth than the White House contends.

The tepid market response to the president's economic policy approach did little to sway Mr. Trump, who chose on Friday to revive the uncertainty that has kept businesses and consumers on edge. The president threatened 50 percent tariffs on the European Union, and a 25 percent tariff on Apple. Other tech companies, he said, could face the same rate.

Since taking office, Mr. Trump has raced to enact his economic vision, aiming to pair generous tax cuts with sweeping deregulation that he says will expand America's economy. He has fashioned his steep, worldwide tariffs as a political cudgel that will raise money, encourage more domestic manufacturing and improve U.S. trade relationships.

But for many of his signature

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More on the White House

NO BARGAINS The U.S. uses tariff talks to pressure rivals. But the E.U. thought it was dealing with an ally. News Analysis. PAGE 4

TARGETS Top universities like Harvard and foreign companies would have higher taxes under a House-passed bill. PAGE 20

Lifestyle to Reverse Alzheimer's Carries High Costs and, Many Say, False Hope

By LINDSAY GELLMAN

Kerry Briggs had trouble keeping track of the supplements. To help, her husband, John Briggs, created a spreadsheet with rows for ashwagandha, Omega-3 and curcumin extract. There was ginseng, lion's mane mushroom and the antioxidant liposomal glutathione, too.

Ms. Briggs, 64, had started taking the supplements last July, a daily regimen that grew to include 34 capsules and tablets along with two scoops of powder. When it became too much, Mr. Briggs began blending them into a shake, to which he added brown food coloring so it looked less like its natural "sickly" olive shade.

Ms. Briggs was taking them all

because a doctor had told her that with enough supplements and lifestyle modifications, her Alzheimer's symptoms could not only be slowed, but be reversed.

It is an idea that has become the focus of television specials, popular podcasts and conferences; the sell behind mushroom supplements and self-help books.

But the suggestion that

Alzheimer's can be reversed through lifestyle adjustments has outraged doctors and scientists in the medical establishment, who have repeatedly said that there is little to no proof for such a claim, and expressed concern that the idea could harm a large group of vulnerable Americans.

Mr. Briggs had come across the idea after learning about Dale

Bredesen, who had been performing a series of small and unconventional studies through which he claimed to have designed a set of guidelines to reverse Alzheimer's symptoms.

"Very, very few people should ever get this," Mr. Bredesen told an audience in July, referring to cognitive decline. His company

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INTERNATIONAL 4-13

Attacks Amid Prisoner Swap

The drone strikes, carried out by both Russia and Ukraine, were a reminder that any diplomatic resolution to the conflict remains far off. PAGE 13

Blouse as 'Ideological Weapon'

The colorfully embroidered Romanian blouse traditionally worn by villagers has been adopted by nationalists as a political symbol. PAGE 6

An Ancient Practice Is Fading

Hong Kong's bamboo scaffolding, a distinctive latticework seen on towers under construction across the city, has begun to give way to metal. PAGE 7



ARTS & LEISURE

Founding Fathers at Odds

A Monticello tour focuses on Thomas Jefferson and John Adams, and what we can learn about U.S. politics. PAGE 6

NATIONAL 14-24

Town Covets Church's Land

A church in New Jersey wants to build a homeless shelter. The mayor is thinking pickleball courts. PAGE 14

Investor Is Accused of Torture

The police said the victim was held for weeks in a Manhattan townhouse in a bid to get his Bitcoin password. PAGE 24

METROPOLITAN

Powerful Men, Dark Mysteries

An F.B.I. investigation and allegations by a woman who said her brother had abused and controlled her for 45 years have shocked a small town. PAGE 1



SUNDAY BUSINESS

How A.I. Is Already at Work

Artificial intelligence has begun to change our jobs and the way we do them. The future can seem both scary and inspiring. PAGE 1

SUNDAY OPINION

Steven Pinker

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SUNDAY STYLES

Local News From Local Teens

The Ditch Weekly, a free paper staffed by middle school and high school students on Long Island, is covering the Hamptons from a new angle. PAGE 4

The Last Lucille Roberts

A forgotten fitness pioneer built an empire on the idea of creating a space for everyday women. Her devotees are still sweating through workouts at a faded gym in Queens. PAGE 1

